

Israeli premier defends his plans for Gaza

Amid global outcry, Netanyahu announces wider assault aimed at destroying Hamas.

By WAFAA SHURAF, SAM METZ AND SAMY MAGDY

JERUSALEM — Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu on Sunday defended a new military offensive in Gaza that's more sweeping than previously announced, declaring in the face of growing condemnation at home and abroad that Israel "has no choice but to finish the job and complete the defeat of Hamas."

Even as more Israelis express concern over the 22-month war, Netanyahu said the security Cabinet last week instructed the dismantling of Hamas strongholds not only in Gaza City but also in the "central camps" and Muwasi. A source familiar with the operation, who spoke on condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to talk to the media, confirmed that Israel plans the operations in both areas.

The crowded camps — sheltering well over a half a million displaced people, according to the United Nations — had not been part of Israel's announcement Friday of the offensive in Gaza City. It was unclear why, though Netanyahu faced criticism this weekend within his ruling coalition that targeting Gaza City was not enough. The prime minister said there would be "safe zones," but such designated areas have been bombed in the past.

Netanyahu's office late Sunday said he had spoken with President Trump about the plan and thanked him for his "steadfast support."

Hours after Netanyahu spoke, broadcaster Al Jazeera announced that one of its correspondents, Anas [See Gaza, A4]



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

THE 777 TOWER sold a year ago for \$120 million, a 70% drop from its 2013 sale price, according to CoStar.

A second act for office towers?

The transformation of a sleek, granite-clad office tower on the edge of the 110 Freeway into deluxe apartments is about to begin, and developer Garrett Lee thinks the nearly 40-year-old building can be competitive with downtown L.A.'s much newer upmarket housing.

A mock-up of an apartment assembled in the L.A. Care tower on 7th Street reveals high ceilings, tall windows and sweeping views of the city that speak to the appeal of urban living.

It could also be a harbinger of what's to become of other fancy office towers.

With downtown's office rental market mired in high vacancies and falling values, stakeholders are clamoring for more city support to convert high-rises to housing that would help address the city's persistent housing shortage.

Amid high vacancies and falling values in downtown L.A.'s rental market, a push is on to boost housing

By Roger Vincent

Among the suggested targets for conversion are elite Financial District towers that commanded top rents before offices were shut down by COVID-19 pandemic stay-at-home orders, leaving many buildings more than one-third vacant.

Failure to make at least some of them into housing could be financially catastrophic for taxpayers, according to a new study commissioned by the Central City Assn. of Los Angeles, a downtown business advocacy group that says the city should consider giving developers financial incentives to convert their buildings.

Office values have fallen dramatically in recent sales, and many owners are seeking public reappraisals of their buildings in hope of reducing their property taxes. When assessed values of buildings [See Offices, A6]

Heat in the fields keeps on killing

20 years after safety law, farmworkers are still getting sick. Some blame Cal/OSHA.

By Jessica Garrison

KNIGHTS LANDING, Calif. — Though it was not yet noon, the temperature was already inching toward triple digits, and it felt even hotter for the scores of farmworkers hunched in the rows

of watermelon plants in this field tucked by a bend in the Sacramento River north of California's capital. They were clad in long-sleeved shirts, pants and face coverings to protect their skin from the sun and the tiny spikes on the watermelon vines, and they were stooping and standing over and over again, painstakingly plucking flowers off each plant.

Their boss, Jose Chavez, said he tries to be vigilant about the danger of heat ill-

ness, making sure there is plenty of drinking water in the fields and that workers can take breaks in the shade and knock off early on blistering days. It's a lesson he said he learned the hard way, after having to summon ambulances to the fields in past summers because workers were hobbled by heat stroke. "We learned from that," he said. "When you start taking people to the hospital, it's not fun."

That lesson, however, has not stuck with many em-

ployers, and 20 years after California enacted a landmark heat safety law, farmworkers across the state are still getting sick and sometimes dying from preventable heat illness. Advocates and some lawmakers say a toothless enforcement system is often to blame.

The law "is failing because of a lack of enforcement. It's not doing what it was intended to do," said state Sen. Dave Cortese (D-San Jose), a former farm- [See Farmworkers, A12]



CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

SYDNEY sticks close by Carrie Henderson outside the Langham Huntington.

COLUMN ONE

From rescued to rescuer

Shy but striking dog adopted from a shelter seems to sense fire evacuees need contact, as does he

By Carrie Henderson

Two years ago, before the Eaton fire would change my life and his, I met Sydney — half German shepherd, half Great Pyrenees and enigma with a capital E.

Two days before I met him, I'd put down Lord Byron, my 15-year-old shepherd rescue, after nursing him for a year. I was a wreck. My friend Bob finally put me in his car, a la "let's just hang out with dogs and stop the tears."

A half-hour later, we walked into West-

side German Shepherd Rescue where, a few feet away, stood this tall, elegant beast of a dog. We looked at each other. I was struck. I ran over, wrapped my arms around him and wouldn't let go. A nervous staffer pulled me away because he was mostly an unknown.

That week, Sydney had arrived from the Apple Valley shelter. He was a runner and escape artist. Too many times. No owner. No tags. No chip. A volunteer brought him to safety in downtown Los [See Evacuees, A12]

Voices PATT MORRISON COLUMNIST

A requiem for L.A.'s lost, loved restaurants

Here we are again, mourning at yet more tombstones in Los Angeles' culinary cemetery, the last resting place of restaurants.

The newest obituary is for the oldest restaurant in the city of L.A., Cole's French Dip, in downtown. It opened in 1908, the year the first Model T rolled off Henry Ford's assembly line. It's a place that I suspect many Angelenos had not heard of until they heard it was closing, so Cole's got a temporary deathbed reprieve because of the crush of people wanting a last — or first and last — meal there.

The Original Pantry Cafe, Cole's younger sibling about a mile away, opened in 1924 and flourished on the

strength of its we-never-close pledge. COVID-19 curtailed its hours, and the Pantry closed altogether this spring, two years after the death of its owner, former Mayor Richard Riordan. Its fare was stick-to-the-ribs and elsewhere kind of food that works wonders on a hangover, as did the coffee that was as thick as the meaty ceramic mugs the waiters kept filled.

Also on the death notice list: La Golondrina, opened in about 1930 in Olvera Street, in a brick building that was nearly 80 years old even then. It closed its double doors last year, doomed by money and legal troubles.

The Pacific Dining Car just west of downtown came up a year short of its centen- [See Morrison, A7]



GINA FERAZZI Los Angeles Times

COLE'S French Dip said it would shut, then delayed its closure when a crush of people descended on it.

Newsom, UC gird to fight Trump penalties

Despite addressing demands, UCLA is hit with a \$1-billion fine. State plans to sue.

By Jaweed Kaleem

Two weeks ago, UCLA was optimistic.

For months, it had successfully avoided clashes with President Trump as university leaders declined to publicly criticize him by name over his battle to remake American higher education, first raging against several Ivy League schools.

The morning of July 29, UCLA announced it had settled a federal lawsuit with students who accused it of discrimination, paying more than \$2 million to Jewish civil rights groups and millions more in legal fees.

University leaders hailed the action as "real progress" to combat antisemitism. Privately, they pointed the Trump administration to the agreement, eager to convince federal officials they had made good with Jewish communities.

The high lasted just a few hours — and touched off an extraordinary 14 days of rapid-fire accusations, investigative findings and a massive federal freeze of UCLA's research funding.

It culminated Friday afternoon when Gov. Gavin Newsom unleashed furious comments in response to a federal demand that UC pay a \$1-billion fine over a host of allegations against UCLA: antisemitism on campus, illegal use of race in admissions and policies that allow transgender athletes to compete according to their gender identity.

"He has threatened us through extortion with a billion-dollar fine, unless we do his bidding," Newsom said, adding that California would sue. "We will not be complicit in this kind of attack on academic freedom on this extraordinary public institution."

Spokespeople for the Justice Department did not respond Sunday to a question about Newsom's comments and legal threat.

The escalating events lead up to decisive moments this week, starting with an emergency meeting of the UC Board of Regents on Monday afternoon. On Tuesday, a federal court hearing will unfold in a pre-existing case that could lead to some — but not all — UC grants being restored.

The developments bring the fight over America's [See UCLA, A6]

CDC shooter blamed vaccine

A union for health agency workers calls on federal officials to condemn misinformation. **NATION, A5**

Newsom faces fossil fuel reality

Governor eases up on his criticism of the oil industry as the closures of two refineries loom. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Good vibrations never fade away

Singer Mike Love shares the Beach Boys' legacy after Brian Wilson's death. **ENTERTAINMENT, E1**

Weather

Sunny and warm. L.A. Basin: 85/65. **B6**

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